

1a) In order to encourage consumers to buy Canadian products, it is important to first understand attitudes that influence their purchasing decisions involving attitudes toward Canadian goods, the Canadian government policies, and the Canadian economy. Given that the attitudes people have toward Canadian goods are decisive in their purchasing decisions, it is important to see if they are positive or not. Additionally, if they believe the government is doing a good job by offering subsidies, protecting jobs, or promoting innovation, this can lead to a more positive view of buying Canadian products. On the other hand, if they think the government is ineffective, they may be less likely to support local products. Furthermore, many consumers care about how their spending affects the Canadian economy. When people believe that buying Canadian goods will help create jobs and strengthen communities, they will be more likely to support domestic products as they wish to enhance the nation's well-being.

1b) Among the attitudes noted above, I would specifically target the attitudes people have toward Canadian goods. To understand how a typical Canadian evaluates these goods, I would use the multiattribute model, which breaks overall evaluations into distinct attributes (quality, price, sustainability, and culture), each rated on a 0–10 scale for both its importance and its performance. A score of 0 refers to the lowest possible rating, while 10 refers to the highest. In general, because typical Canadians tend to care most about quality and price, I would assign an importance of 9 for the quality of goods and an 8 for their price. In view of the growing concerns about climate change, I would set sustainability at 7. Although cultural aspects help to understand how people view a brand, they are not as important as quality and price when making a purchase, so I would set culture at a 5.

Below is a speculative multiattribute model comparing Canadian brands (Tim Hortons and Lululemon as a representative) with non-Canadian brands (Starbucks and Adidas):

Attribute	Importance	Score			
		Tim Hortons (Canadian)	Starbuck (Non Canadian)	Lulu lemon (Canadian)	Adidas (Non Canadian)
Quality	9	6	8	8	9
Price	8	9	6	6	8
Sustainability	7	7	7	5	6
Culture	5	9	5	7	5
Weighted Average		220	194	190	212

The multiattribute model suggests that typical Canadian consumers see only a slight difference between Canadian and non-Canadian brands, indicating no strong preference for either one. While Canadian brands score higher when viewed through a cultural lens, this factor holds relatively low importance in purchasing decisions as compared to quality and price, where non-Canadian brands often perform just as well or even better. Sustainability is becoming more important, yet Canadian brands, particularly in sportswear as is the case with Lululemon, still score lower in this area.

1c) There are several situations in which attitudes are the most likely to predict consumer behavior including when there are no situational constraints, when attitudes are strong and easily recalled, and when they are measured close to the time of purchase. Hence, to predict consumer behavior, building on the multiattribute model described above that measure customer attitudes, I will conduct a survey that looks at the respondents' overall attitude Canadian goods by asking questions about their attitudes toward a number of distinctly Canadian brands such as Tim Hortons, Canadian Tire, Lululemon, Canada Dry, Air Canada, and RBC on a seven-point scale, where 1 means "extremely positive," 4 is neutral, and 7 means "extremely negative" to capture the direction and strength of their attitudes. Mentioning several Canadian brands help to understand consumer attitudes not just towards a specific brand but ultimately towards overall Canadian goods.

Then, I will go on to assess the consumers' behavioral intentions by asking specific questions like, "How likely are you to purchase a Canadian brand on your next shopping trip?" and "If given a choice between a Canadian and a non-Canadian product with similar features, how likely would you be to choose the Canadian option?" using a scale where 1 means "extremely likely" and 7 means "extremely unlikely".

Additionally, to further capture consumer behavior and the factors influencing their choices, I will present respondents with behavior-related statements such as "I actively seek out Canadian brands when shopping," "I believe buying Canadian-made products has a significant impact on the economy," and "Price is more important to me than whether a product is Canadian-made." and ask them to rate their agreement on a seven-point scale with 1 being strongly agree and 7 being strongly disagree.

By using this survey approach, I will capture the relationship between consumer attitudes and their actual purchasing behavior. Measuring attitudes on a seven-point scale reveals not only whether consumers view Canadian goods positively or negatively but also how strongly they feel, which influences purchasing decisions. Asking about behavioral intentions, such as the likelihood of choosing a Canadian brand, helps me see if their opinions lead to real purchases. Adding questions about shopping habits, like whether price or availability matters more, helps me find out what might stop them from buying Canadian products. By combining these questions, I will get a clear picture of how attitudes predict behaviour.

2. To change consumer attitudes toward Canadian goods, I will use insights from the multiattribute model. Although Canadian products already score high on cultural authenticity, many consumers do not consider culture a major factor when making purchase decisions. Thus, one strategy to change customer attitudes towards Canadian goods is to increase the importance of cultural aspects. To achieve this, I will launch an ad campaign that emphasizes the importance of Canadian culture. For example, the campaign could use borrowed interest strategy by featuring a respected Canadian actress who embodies national pride and authenticity, asking, "If we don't support Canadian culture, who will?" This message would be backed by data showing how buying Canadian goods strengthens local communities and preserves our heritage. By combining Canadian actress with data, the ads could appeal to both central and peripheral route people. A second strategy is to improve evaluations on attributes where Canadian goods may be lacking, such as sustainability. This can be achieved by highlighting eco-friendly practices and certifications through clear, data driven messaging.

Finally, a comparative message, I would make ads that compare Canadian goods and non Canadian goods while highlighting the unique benefits of Canadian products without criticizing foreign brands. For example, an ad might emphasize that buying Canadian not only means getting high quality but also helps create jobs and strengthens Canadian communities. Another example is contrasting a Canadian food product with a foreign alternative, emphasizing fresher local ingredients and shorter supply chains, which contribute to better quality and reduced environmental impact. The campaign can encourage consumers to view domestic products as superior. This respectful comparison helps reinforce positive attitudes and motivates consumers to choose Canadian products while ensuring that the message remains non-offensive.

3. Despite positive attitudes toward Canadian goods, many external factors can prevent these attitudes from leading to actual purchases. Consumers might still buy imported products due to factors like store location, convenience, habitual buying, and strong promotions for foreign brands. Thus, to get people to behave more in-line with existing positive attitudes, I will create an ad that showcases the dissonance between Canadians who take pride in supporting their country and love Canadian culture (illustrated through someone who collects Canadian symbols like flags and maple leaves keychains) but still habitually buy foreign brands. The ad will also provide information about the negative impact of buying imports on local businesses and jobs in Canada, emphasizing how this contradicts their national pride. By emphasizing this inconsistency, the ad will create cognitive dissonance, which, according to balance theory, will push consumers to restore consistency by consciously choosing Canadian products. Additionally, practical steps like improved store signage, better product placement, and targeted incentives (e.g., discounts or loyalty programs) for Canadian products can help overcome situational barriers and encourage local buying.